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Beyond digital infrastructure

Artificial intelligence (AI) as the intelligence layer of India's financial ecosystem



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Foreword by KPMG in India

India's fintech sector is at a pivotal juncture in its evolution. Over the past decade, the country has built a robust digital finance ecosystem, powered by Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI), widespread digital adoption, progressive regulatory frameworks and a thriving culture of innovation. As this ecosystem continues to evolve, artificial intelligence (AI) is emerging as the next transformative force, reshaping how financial services are designed, delivered and scaled.

As the knowledge partner for the 3rd India International Fintech Festival 2026, organised by ASSOCHAM in support of the Ministry of Finance, MeitY, RBI and IFSCA, we are pleased to contribute to this forum which brings together policymakers, regulators, financial institutions, technology providers, fintech startups, investors and industry experts to exchange perspectives on the future of digital finance and financial innovation. The event serves as a strategic platform for dialogue, collaboration and innovation across India's evolving fintech ecosystem.

As part of this collaboration, we present our thought leadership report, 'Beyond digital infrastructure: AI as the intelligence layer of India's financial ecosystem'. The report explores how AI is evolving from a technology that supports analytical decision-making into a foundational capability that can autonomously execute, optimise and enhance fintech capabilities to deliver value across the financial services (FS) domain. This shift represents more than a technology evolution. It signals a transition from digital finance, built on infrastructure and connectivity, towards intelligent finance, where AI increasingly becomes the layer that enables smarter decisions, adaptive experiences and more autonomous financial operations.

India is uniquely positioned to lead this transformation. While DPI has established the foundation for digital financial innovation, AI has the potential to become the next strategic layer of value creation across the ecosystem, enabling organisations to enhance decision-making, automate complex processes and unlock new opportunities for operational excellence and customer-centric innovation. The combination of rich digital data ecosystems, expanding digital connectivity and a supportive policy environment further strengthens India's readiness to adopt advanced AI capabilities at scale. Emerging agentic AI use cases are enabling new possibilities, from hyper-personalised financial experiences and intelligent assistants to autonomous workflows, alternative credit assessment and real-time fraud detection.

As AI adoption continues to gain momentum, the industry is moving from experimentation to execution. Organisations are increasingly looking beyond pilot programmes to enterprise-wide deployment, with a growing focus on translating AI investments into measurable business outcomes across operations, compliance, risk management and business performance. This reinforces a broader shift in which organisations are moving beyond isolated use cases and embedding AI across core business functions to drive efficiency, resilience, productivity and business performance. Furthermore, AI evangelism is increasingly transcending organisational hierarchies, contributing to the development of innovation-driven cultures across organisations.

At the same time, as AI becomes more deeply embedded in financial decisions and operations, trust could emerge as a key differentiator. Responsible AI adoption may be essential to ensuring that innovation is accompanied by transparency, fairness, accountability, security and regulatory compliance. Building robust governance frameworks and establishing clear guardrails around AI development and deployment may be critical to enabling organisations to scale AI confidently while maintaining stakeholder trust and ensuring responsible, ethical and sustainable innovation across India's financial ecosystem.

Five years ago, fintechs were widely regarded as the disruptors in the FS landscape. Today, however, disruption is no longer confined to fintechs; organisations across the FS ecosystem are leveraging AI to create differentiated value. The next phase of India's fintech growth could depend on the delivery of AI technologies to its customer ecosystem, along with the enablement of stakeholders across government, regulators and financial institutions. Further, investing in future-ready talent and research could be critical to sustaining India's leadership in digital finance.

I believe India's next phase of fintech leadership is likely to be defined not by digital infrastructure alone, but by how effectively intelligence is embedded across the fintech ecosystem. If harnessed responsibly and at scale, AI could become a powerful catalyst for innovation, inclusion, resilience and long-term value creation.



Akhilesh Tuteja

Head – Clients and Markets
KPMG in India

MeitY: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, RBI: Reserve Bank of India, IFSCA: International Financial Services Centres Authority

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Foreword by KPMG in India

India's fintech story over the past decade has been one of building trust at population scale.

Through Aadhaar, the country established a trusted identity layer. Through UPI, it created one of the world's largest real-time payment ecosystems, processing more than USD3.5 trillion in transaction value during FY26[1]. Through DigiLocker and the Account Aggregator framework, India enabled secure access to records and consent-based data sharing across hundreds of millions of users and billions of connected accounts. These foundational capabilities have transformed financial inclusion, accelerated innovation and enabled broader participation in the formal economy.

The next phase of India's fintech journey will be defined by embedding intelligence across the financial ecosystem alongside robust and world-class infrastructure.

As financial institutions gain access to increasingly rich streams of transaction, identity and behavioural data, AI is emerging as the intelligence layer that enables organisations to transform information into insight, insight into decisions and decisions into action. Across payments, lending, insurance, wealth management and regulatory compliance, AI is increasingly becoming embedded within core operating models, helping organisations enhance customer experiences, strengthen risk management, improve efficiency and unlock new sources of growth.

What makes this moment particularly significant is that India enters the AI era with a unique set of advantages. The country's Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI), extensive digital adoption, thriving fintech sector and progressive policy initiatives collectively create conditions that few can replicate. India today ranks among the world's leading fintech ecosystems, supported by nearly 17,000 fintech firms[2] and one of the largest digital transaction processing ecosystem. Together, these strengths position India not only to scale AI adoption, but also to shape the future of responsible AI in financial services globally.

The industry's momentum is already evident. Financial institutions are increasingly moving beyond experimentation towards enterprise-wide deployment of AI capabilities. Organisations are demonstrating growing confidence in scaling AI initiatives across customer engagement, fraud detection, compliance, operations and decision-making, with a clear focus on generating measurable business outcomes. Increasing investments, stronger executive sponsorship and rising AI maturity levels signal that AI is no longer being viewed solely as a productivity enhancer, but as a strategic capability capable of driving innovation, competitiveness and long-term value creation.

At the same time, the ability to scale AI successfully and realise value will depend on combining technological readiness and organisational readiness while maintaining trust. Organisations must invest both in technology, including AI-ready data and in operating model redesign across people, processes, governance and change management. Organisations that will accrue competitive advantage will be the ones that best align technology and people capability around AI-driven transformation.

As AI systems evolve from supporting decisions to increasingly autonomous execution of activities and workflows, organisations will need to ensure that transparency, fairness, accountability, security and resilience remain embedded in their AI strategies. The emergence of initiatives such as the IndiaAI Mission and the Reserve Bank of India's FREE-AI framework reflects the growing importance of balancing innovation with appropriate governance and risk management.

Looking ahead, India's opportunity extends beyond the adoption of AI technologies. Building the future of India's fintech ecosystem will require coordinated efforts to expand AI-ready infrastructure, strengthen responsible AI governance, scale AI across core financial functions, enable trusted agentic AI ecosystems, design inclusive human-computer experiences and harness India's growing data strengths to develop contextually relevant AI capabilities. These priorities will be critical in translating technological potential into sustainable economic and societal value.

The 3rd India International Fintech Festival 2026, organised by ASSOCHAM, comes at a pivotal moment for the industry. As AI moves from experimentation to enterprise-scale transformation, the conversation is shifting from whether organisations should adopt AI to how they can deploy it responsibly, securely and at scale. This report contributes to that discussion by examining how AI is reshaping financial services today and highlighting the strategic priorities that could define the next chapter of India's fintech leadership.

India's fintech success has always been rooted in its ability to convert innovation into trust at scale. The next decade presents an opportunity to extend that trust into the age of intelligent systems. If harnessed responsibly, AI has the potential to become not merely a technology layer, but the intelligence layer that powers a more inclusive, resilient and globally competitive financial ecosystem for India.



Hemant Jhajhria
Head of Consulting
KPMG in India

1. UPI completes 10 glorious years, Emerges as World's Largest Real-Time Payments Platform, Anchoring India's Digital Economy, PIB, 30 April 2026
2. Fintech sector as of 24 July 2026, Tracxn, accessed on 24 July 2026

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Foreword by ASSOCHAM

India's financial sector is entering a new era of transformation. Having built one of the world's most advanced digital public infrastructures, the country is now poised to harness the power of Artificial Intelligence to create a financial ecosystem that is more intelligent, inclusive, resilient and globally competitive.

The convergence of AI with Digital Public Infrastructure, digital payments and a thriving FinTech ecosystem marks a defining moment in India's growth story. AI is no longer simply an emerging technology—it is becoming a strategic capability that is reshaping how financial institutions innovate, manage risk, strengthen customer trust, improve operational efficiency and deliver inclusive financial services at scale.

The Indian economy demonstrates strong resilience despite current global uncertainties arising from geopolitical tensions, rising energy prices and supply chain disruptions. It grew at 7.7 per cent in FY 2025–26[1]. Exports have been making new highs every year over the last five years, reaching USD863.1 billion in FY2025-26[2] and in the current year, exports recorded growth of 11.37 per cent during April-June 2026[3]. The manufacturing sector also witnessed a robust growth of 10.7 per cent in FY2025-26[4]. Forex Reserves stood in a comfortable position at USD 676 billion[5].

Robust domestic demand, stable inflation, sustained manufacturing growth and healthy exports continue to support the economic growth trajectory. Economic indicators such as GST collections, PMI, vehicle sales and infrastructure activity reflect the strength of the Indian economy. India's growing network of Free Trade Agreements is increasing access to global markets, elevating export competitiveness and creating new opportunities for businesses. With strong foreign exchange reserves, a stable financial system and continued policy support for industry and MSMEs, India is in a strong position to build its growth momentum and strengthen its role in the global economy.

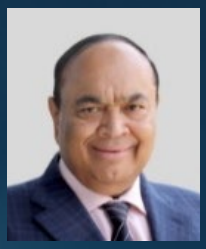
As India progresses towards the vision of **Viksit Bharat 2047,** the opportunity before us extends beyond technology adoption. It is about creating an ecosystem where innovation is guided by trust, where governance evolves alongside technological advancement and where collaboration between government, regulators, industry, academia and startups accelerates sustainable economic growth.

This joint ASSOCHAM–KPMG in India thought leadership report, **"Beyond Digital Infrastructure: AI as the Intelligence Layer of India's Financial Ecosystem,"** captures this pivotal transition. It brings together industry perspectives, emerging trends, practical use cases and policy considerations that will shape the next generation of AI-enabled financial services. The report underscores the importance of building responsible AI frameworks while enabling innovation that enhances competitiveness and expands access to financial services for businesses and citizens alike.

At ASSOCHAM, we believe that the future of financial services will be defined not only by technological excellence but also by responsible leadership, collaborative policymaking and a shared commitment to creating long-term value for society. Through the **3rd India International FinTech Festival 2026** organized by ASSOCHAM, we are proud to provide a platform where policymakers, regulators, financial institutions, technology companies, startups and global thought leaders can collectively shape the future of India's digital economy.

I congratulate KPMG in India for partnering with ASSOCHAM in developing this insightful report and extend my appreciation to all contributors whose expertise has enriched its contents. I am confident that this report will serve as a valuable guide for business leaders, policymakers, regulators, investors and innovators as they navigate the evolving landscape of AI-powered financial services.

As India builds the next chapter of its digital economy, let us work together to help ensure that Artificial Intelligence becomes a force for innovation, inclusion, trust and sustainable growth—strengthening India's position as a global leader in digital finance.



Nirmal Kumar Minda

President

ASSOCHAM

1. Prime Minister highlights strong growth momentum of Indian economy, PIB, 5 June 2026
2. India's Exports Scale Record US$ 863.1 Billion in FY 2025–26, Driven by Strong Trade with UAE, UK and Australia, PIB, 28 July 2026
3. The cumulative exports (merchandise & services) during April-June 2026-27 is estimated at US$ 232.73 Billion, as compared to US$ 208.98 Billion in April-June 2025-26, an estimated growth of 11.37%, PIB, 13 July 2026
4. Provisional estimates of annual Gross Domestic Product for 2025-26 and quarterly estimates of Gross Domestic Product for the fourth quarter (January-March) of 2025-26, PIB, 5 June 2026
5. RBI Weekly Statistical Supplement, as on 17 July 2026

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Foreword by ASSOCHAM

It is my privilege to present the joint ASSOCHAM–KPMG in India thought leadership report**, "Beyond Digital Infrastructure: AI as the Intelligence Layer of India's Financial Ecosystem,"** on the occasion of the **3rd India International FinTech Festival 2026,** organized by ASSOCHAM

India's digital transformation has established a strong foundation for innovation in financial services. The rapid adoption of Digital Public Infrastructure, digital payments, Open Networks and a vibrant FinTech ecosystem has positioned the country as a global leader in digital finance. As we enter the next phase of this journey, Artificial Intelligence is emerging as the intelligence layer that will redefine how financial institutions operate, innovate, manage risk and deliver trusted, customer-centric services.

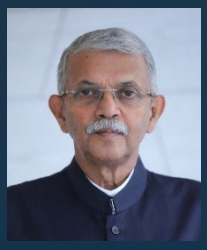
AI has the potential to transform every aspect of the financial ecosystem—from enhancing financial inclusion and strengthening fraud detection to improving credit assessment, regulatory compliance, customer engagement and operational efficiency. However, realizing this potential requires a balanced approach that combines innovation with robust governance, ethical AI practices, cybersecurity and consumer trust.

This report explores how AI can rapidly enable Fintechs, which is one of the key enablers of the Nation's financial services environment, helping scale capabilities of consumer organizations such as Banks, NBFCs, Insurers, Capital Markets companies and compliance with key regulatory asks. Adoption and adaption of AI enabled capabilities is key to rapid development of entire sector. It also highlights the collaborative role of government, industry, technology providers and academia in building an AI-enabled financial ecosystem that is secure, inclusive, resilient and globally competitive.

I extend my sincere appreciation to KPMG for partnering with ASSOCHAM in developing this thought leadership report. I also thank our distinguished policymakers, regulators, industry leaders and experts whose valuable insights and perspectives have enriched this report.

I hope this report serves as a valuable reference for policymakers, financial institutions, technology providers, investors, researchers and all stakeholders committed to shaping the next generation of India's financial ecosystem. I am confident that the ideas and recommendations presented herein will contribute meaningfully to advancing responsible AI adoption and fostering sustainable innovation across the financial sector.

I wish the **3rd India International FinTech Festival 2026,** organized by ASSOCHAM every success and look forward to continued collaboration in building a smarter, safer and more inclusive financial future for India.



Saurabh Sanyal

Secretary General
ASSOCHAM

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Executive summary

India's fintech sector is undergoing a significant transformation, where AI is evolving from a tool for automation and analytics into a strategic driver of innovation, efficiency and value creation. Enabled by India's robust DPI and a rapidly maturing digital ecosystem, fintech firms are increasingly leveraging AI, generative AI (GenAI) and emerging agentic AI capabilities to enhance customer experiences, strengthen risk management and unlock new business models. As organisations move from experimentation to scaled deployment, the focus is shifting towards responsible adoption, measurable outcomes and building an AI-native financial ecosystem capable of driving sustainable growth and global competitiveness.

Key developments shaping AI adoption

Over the past 12 months, advances in AI capabilities and a sharper focus on business outcomes have accelerated adoption across financial services.

The AI journey is increasingly evolving towards scaled deployment, supported by the emergence of agentic AI frameworks, growing efforts to quantify business value and expanding role of AI in enhancing decision-making and workflow automation. At the same time, heightened expectations around accountability, model risk management and data governance are reshaping implementation approaches, making responsible and well-governed AI a strategic imperative for fintech companies.

DPI as the foundation for AI innovation

UPI

>USD3.5 trillion
transaction value in FY26, 20.6 per cent YoY growth

Account aggregator

>2.9 billion
financial accounts integrated into the ecosystem

AI-enabled KYC

Streamlines onboarding and delivers significant cost efficiencies

DigiLocker

723.6 million
users across India's digital document ecosystem

ONDC

>200 million
buyers and 0.5 million sellers have been connected through ONDC ecosystem as of Jun'26

Together, these platforms enable trusted digital identity, seamless payments, consent-based data sharing and secure document access, improving financial inclusion, operational efficiency and deployment of advanced AI technologies.

Strong AI returns are accelerating adoption and spending

Indian financial organisations are advancing AI deployments from pilots to production at scale, demonstrating growing momentum in embedding AI across the enterprise and enabling value creation across multiple use cases.

Rising AI investments underscore the growing strategic importance of AI, reflecting enhanced organisational commitment to accelerating adoption and advancing business transformation objectives.

Strategic priorities to further strengthen AI adoption

- Build scalable AI infrastructure, interoperable data ecosystems and compute capacity
- Enable trusted AI through robust governance, transparency and risk management
- Embed AI across financial workflows to drive efficiency, accuracy and growth
- Advance autonomous AI agents with secure, trusted and accountable deployment
- Design innovative HCI that make digital financial services seamless for diverse customer segments
- Harness India's data strength to build indigenous, contextually relevant AI models

UPI: Unified Payments Interface, KYC: Know your customer, ONDC: Open Network for Digital Commerce, HCI: Human Computer Interaction

Note: 1. Sources for the data indicated here are provided in the subsequent sections. 2. Currency conversion for the UPI value is based on an average exchange rate of USD1 = INR88.30 for FY26, taken from RBI database on Indian Economy

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Foundations for the next phase of fintech growth

India’s fintech sector has grown into one of the world's most robust and rapidly evolving digital financial ecosystems, driven by a unique convergence of technological innovation, supportive regulation, expanding internet penetration and widespread adoption of DPI. Today, fintech companies are reshaping traditional banking through seamless digital payments, wealth management platforms, insurtech solutions and emerging applications of AI. With a large underserved population, growing smartphone usage and increasing investor interest, India’s fintech landscape is moving beyond financial inclusion towards creating a more integrated and innovation-led financial ecosystem.

India’s fintech funding landscape

3rd

globally in fintech equity funding in 2025, surpassing **USD2.4 billion**, following the U.S. and the U.K.[1]

USD1.2 billion

in early-stage fintech funding in 2025, up 78 per cent y-o-y from 2024[1]

- The sector is shifting from rapid expansion towards sustainable, long-term growth and resilience
- Investors are increasingly backing fintechs with proven business models, clear profitability pathways and strong governance, rather than prioritising growth.

Key enablers supporting future growth

A combination of strong demand fundamentals, ecosystem maturity and enabling market conditions continue to reinforce the fintech sector's long-term growth outlook. Together, these factors are strengthening India's position as a leading force in the global fintech ecosystem.

Digital public infrastructure	Enabling seamless payments, digital identity verification and secure data sharing, accelerating innovation and reducing customer acquisition costs
Innovation ecosystems	Fostering the development of innovation hubs, accelerators and industry partnerships fosters collaboration and the rapid scaling of fintech solutions
Regulatory and compliance	Streamlining regulations, improve compliance processes and enhance regulatory clarity support innovation and scaling
Data security and privacy	Strengthening trust in digital financial services through sustained investments in cybersecurity, privacy safeguards and data protection practices
AI and data infrastructure	Expanding AI infrastructure and computing capacity to drive faster innovation, enhanced risk management and greater operational efficiency
Wealth and insurance penetration	Growing demand for investment and protection products is creating opportunities beyond payments and lending

1. India ranks third globally in FinTech funding with $2.4 billion raised in 2025, Tracxn, 19 January 2026

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India's position in the global fintech landscape

The strong momentum observed in India's fintech sector has positioned the country among the world's leading digital finance ecosystems. However, sustaining this momentum may require progression from scale-led growth to innovation-led leadership.

The table below benchmarks India against leading global fintech markets, highlighting its standing across industry maturity and capital attraction.

Parameters	India's rank	India	U.S.	U.K.	Canada	Australia	China
Number of fintech firms[1]	3rd	16,976	50,853	18,630	5,685	4,695	4,504
Number of fintech unicorns[1]	4th	30	201	41	10	3	38
Total funding in fintech sector (USD billion)[1]	4th	37.3	366.0	99.1	25.1	13.6	42.2
Mobile point of sale payments (million users)[2]	2nd	358.2	272.9	53.2	30.5	20.9	1,046.5

Note: Countries included in the table above were identified and shortlisted based on the highest number of fintech firms globally. India's rank shown in the table is relative to this benchmark group across each assessed parameter.

The effectiveness of a fintech ecosystem is increasingly shaped by the policy environment supporting AI innovation. Leading economies have launched national AI strategies aimed at enhancing technological capabilities, driving industry adoption and establishing governance frameworks to unlock the next phase of fintech growth.

Global AI policies shaping innovation

India
- IndiaAI Mission (2024)
- National Strategy for Artificial Intelligence (2018)

U.S.
- America's AI Action Plan (2025)
- Safe, Secure and Trustworthy Development and Use of Artificial Intelligence (2023)

U.K.
- AI Opportunities Action Plan (2025)
- National AI Strategy (2021)

Canada
- Canada's National Artificial Intelligence Strategy: AI for All (2026)
- Pan-Canadian Artificial Intellegence Strategy (launched: 2017, modified: 2026)

Australia
- National AI Plan (2025)
- Australia's AI Ethics Principles (launched: 2019, updated: 2025)

China
- China - Generative AI Services Management (2023) (Interim measures for the administration generative AI services)
- Plan for Development of the New Generation of Artificial Intelligence (2017)

The next phase of fintech evolution might be defined by the convergence of AI, capital and policy, creating new opportunities for ecosystem differentiation and value creation.

1. Fintech sector as of 24 July 2026, Tracxn, accessed on 24 July 2026
2. Digital Payments: Market data and analysis as of 2025, Statista market insights, accessed on 24 July 2026

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Policy architecture for responsible AI adoption

As AI adoption accelerates across industries, effective governance is becoming critical to ensuring responsible and scalable deployment. India's AI ecosystem is supported by the IndiaAI Mission and FREE-AI framework introduced by the RBI, which guide the responsible and ethical adoption of AI within financial services. Together, these initiatives demonstrate how economy-wide AI enablement and sector-specific governance can reinforce one another, creating a trusted environment for AI-led innovation in finance.

IndiaAI Mission

USD1.25 billion
Allocated under Union Budget 2024[1]*

7
Strategic pillars of AI ecosystem[1]

RBI FREE AI

7
Sutras delivered through 6 pillars[2]

26
Priority actions defined[2]

*The IndiaAI Mission allocation announced in the Union Budget 2024 is phased over a five-year implementation period. Currency conversion for the IndiaAI Mission is based on an exchange rate of USD1 = INR82.90 as of 1 March 2024

Blending RBI Free AI framework with India AI Mission

7 Pillars of IndiaAI Mission

IndiaAI Compute	Application Development Initiative (IADI)	AI Kosh Platform	IndiaAI Innovation Centre	IndiaAI future skills	IndiaAI startup financing	Safe and trusted AI
38,000 GPUs[1]	Enables AI innovation to solve real-world public-sector challenges	13,813 datasets[4]	Indigenous foundational model including LLMs	500 PhD fellows[1]	Promoting regional inclusivity in AI innovation (Tier-II and -III cities)	Focused on bias mitigation, privacy preserving system design
Upto 40 per cent of reduced costs[3]	Promotes development, piloting and adoption of impactful AI solutions	329 AI models[4]	Aligned with India's linguistic and socio-economical diversity	570+ AI/Data labs planned in Tier-II and -III cities[1]	Aims to support 10 Indian AI startups by leveraging the European market[1]	Algorithmic auditing tools and risk assessment framework

7 Sutras of the RBI FREE-AI Framework[2]

- Trust is the foundation
- People first
- Innovation over restraint
- Fairness and equity
- Accountability
- Understandable by design
- Safety, resilience and sustainability

FREE AI: Framework for Responsible and Ethical Enablement of Artificial Intelligence, GPU: Graphics processing unit, LLMs: Large Language Models and PhD: Doctor of Philosophy

1. Transforming India with AI, PIB, 12 October 2025
2. FREE AI Committee report, RBI, 13 August 2025
3. IndiaAI Compute Capacity, IndiaAI, accessed on 24 July 2026
4. AIKosh platform, IndiaAI, accessed on 24 July 2026

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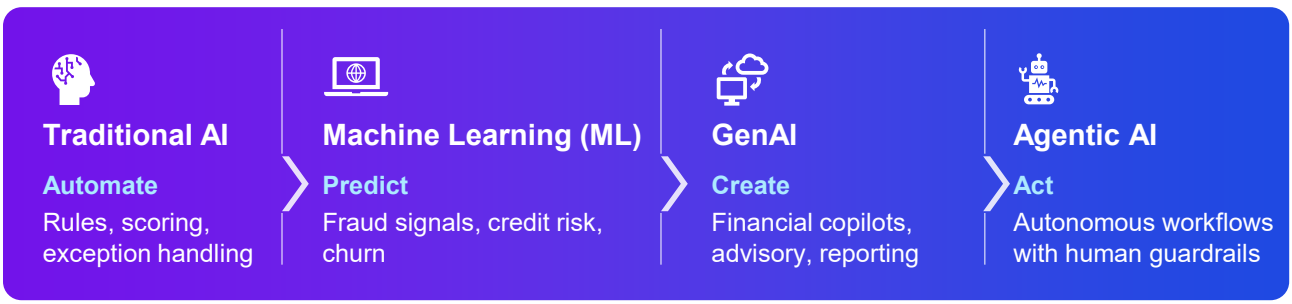
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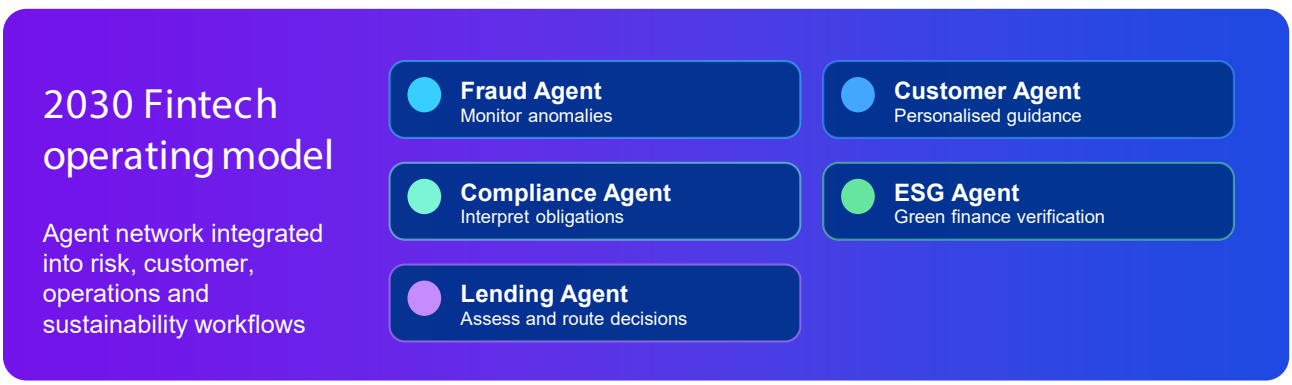
1. Advancing AI in fintech from analytics to autonomous action

India's fintech sector is increasingly leveraging artificial intelligence (AI) to enhance fraud detection, credit assessment, risk management and customer engagement through data-driven insights. As AI adoption deepens, the industry is evolving beyond automation towards autonomous systems capable of analysing information, making decisions and executing financial tasks with minimal human intervention. This shift is redefining operational efficiency, scalability and customer value creation, positioning AI as a key driver of the next phase of fintech innovation in India.

Evolution of AI capabilities in fintech

India’s fintech ecosystem is advancing into a new era of AI-driven transformation. While traditional AI and machine learning continue to underpin core applications, their growth is stabilising as adoption matures. At the same time, generative AI (GenAI) and agentic AI are gaining momentum, unlocking advanced capabilities such as autonomous decision-making, hyper-personalised customer experiences, intelligent financial assistants, automated compliance and risk management. These technologies are accelerating innovation and creating opportunities for efficiency and growth across the fintech value chain.





Emerging opportunities	Trends
GenAI	Transforming customer engagement, advisory, underwriting, risk assessment and operational efficiency through advanced data processing and content generation
Agentic AI	Enabling autonomous decision-making, workflow automation, fraud monitoring and inclusive lending through alternative data-driven credit assessment
Embedded insurance	Integrating contextual insurance products into digital commerce, travel, healthcare and financial platforms to improve distribution and customer reach
Wealth advisory	Delivering personalised investment recommendations, portfolio monitoring and financial planning through AI-driven insights and digital advisors

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Converting AI potential into enterprise-wide transformation

The rapid progression from traditional AI and ML to GenAI and agentic AI is driving a fundamental transformation across fintech. Rather than simply enhancing existing processes, advanced AI is redefining how institutions operate, compete and deliver value. As intelligence becomes embedded within workflows, decision-making and customer interactions, fintechs are moving away from static, human-centric operating models towards adaptive, continuously learning and increasingly autonomous enterprises. This transition is reshaping key functions across the organisation, from lending and fraud management to product development, compliance and innovation.

Area	Traditional fintech model	AI-native fintech model
Credit decisioning	A single point-in-time score at loan origination	Continuously reassessing borrower risk based on real-time financial behaviour and contextual data
Fraud response	Blocking a transaction after a suspicious pattern is confirmed	Pre-empting fraud through early signal detection and proactive intervention
Product design	Building one product for a broad customer segment	Dynamically assembling personalised products from modular components
Regulatory reporting	Compiling reports at the end of a filing cycle	Maintaining a continuous compliance posture with on-demand reporting
Cost structure	Cost scales with transaction or customer volume	Decoupling growth from transaction volumes through scalable AI and data infrastructure
Institutional memory	Knowledge held by individual underwriters and analysts	Embedding institutional knowledge into AI models and reusable decision frameworks
Innovation cycle	New products require months or quarters to develop and test	Accelerating product experimentation and deployment through AI-enabled development

While AI is redefining fintech operating models, its impact depends on access to reliable data, digital identity and connected financial ecosystems. India's DPI stack provides these critical building blocks, enabling financial institutions to deploy AI solutions at scale, accelerate innovation and deliver more intelligent, personalised and inclusive financial services.

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DPI as a foundation for AI-driven fintech innovation

DPI serves as the foundational enabler of AI adoption in the fintech ecosystem by enabling trusted digital identity through Aadhaar, seamless digital payments via Unified Payments Interface (UPI), consent-driven data sharing through the Account Aggregator (AA) framework and digital transaction execution through DigiLocker and eSign. Together, these capabilities improve data availability, financial inclusion, fraud prevention and deployment of next-generation technologies such as GenAI and agentic AI.

UPI

>USD3.5 trillion in UPI transaction value was recorded in FY26, with a y-o-y growth of 20.6 per cent[1]

AA

>2.9 billion financial accounts are connected to the Account Aggregator ecosystem[2]

KYC enabled by AI

AI-powered KYC streamlines onboarding, delivers significant cost efficiencies and enhances compliance

DigiLocker

723.6 million Total users on the DigiLocker platform[3]

ONDC

>200 million Buyers and 0.5 million sellers have been connected through ONDC ecosystem as of Jun'26[4]

AI enhancing India's DPI ecosystem

Enhances UPI transactions with AI-powered assistance and real-time query resolution	Improves transparency and auditability through AI agent decisions that are traceable and explainable	Supports digital onboarding and reduces identity impersonation and synthetic identity fraud	Enables document verification and anomaly detection in automated enrolment processes	Enables personalised customer interactions through AI-powered product discovery

Key drivers accelerating AI adoption in fintech

The increasing focus on digital transformation, resilient risk frameworks, data-driven decision-making and inclusive financial services is accelerating AI adoption across the fintech ecosystem.

- Driving AI adoption through **personalised financial experiences** and digital engagement
- **Enhancing regulatory compliance** through automated KYC, reporting and audit processes
- **Unlocking data-driven insights** for better decisions, risk assessment and service delivery
- **Strengthening fraud, cyber and risk management** with real-time monitoring
- **Improving operational efficiency** through process automation and workflow optimisation
- **Expanding FI and customer service** via alternative credit assessment and AI-driven service delivery

ONDC: Open Network for Digital Commerce, KYC: Know your customer, FI: Financial inclusion

1. UPI completes 10 glorious years, Emerges as World's Largest Real-Time Payments Platform, Anchoring India's Digital Economy, PIB, 30 April 2026
2. Account Aggregator Framework, Department of Financial Services, accessed on 29 July 2026
3. DigiLocker National Statistics, DigiLocker, accessed on 29 July 2026
4. The Digital India: 11 Years of Transformation, PIB, 27 June 2026

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AI applications across the fintech ecosystem

AI is emerging as a critical value accelerator across the fintech ecosystem, enabling organisations to unlock new efficiencies, enhance decision-making and deliver more personalised customer experiences. From automating operational workflows and strengthening risk management to improving regulatory compliance and customer engagement, fintechs are increasingly embedding AI into core business functions to drive productivity, innovation and sustainable growth.

Fintech sub-segments	Customer experience	Risk and fraud	Operations	Compliance management
Payments	Personalised merchant insights	Real-time payment fraud detection	Invoice processing workflows	Digital KYC identity verification
	Customer support chatbots	Transaction anomaly pattern detection	Dispute management automation	Anti-money laundering (AML) screening
Insurtech	Policy recommendation engine	Fraud network detection	Claims processing automation	Regulatory report generation
	Personalised proactive risk prevention	Automated underwriting risk assessment	Document extraction	Policy compliance checks
Regtech	Regulatory advisory copilots	Regulatory gap analysis	Automated regulatory filing workflows	Regulatory change monitoring
	Regulatory knowledge assistants	Fraud analytics	Policy management	Audit trail management
Wealthtech	Robo-advisory platforms	Portfolio risk monitoring	Client onboarding automation	Investor protection checks
	Personalised financial planning	Investment suitability assessment	Report generation	Disclosure management processes



As AI adoption accelerates across fintech segments, the technology is becoming increasingly embedded in core business functions. By enhancing customer experiences, streamlining operations, strengthening risk controls and improving compliance outcomes, AI is helping fintechs drive efficiency, innovation and competitive advantage at scale.

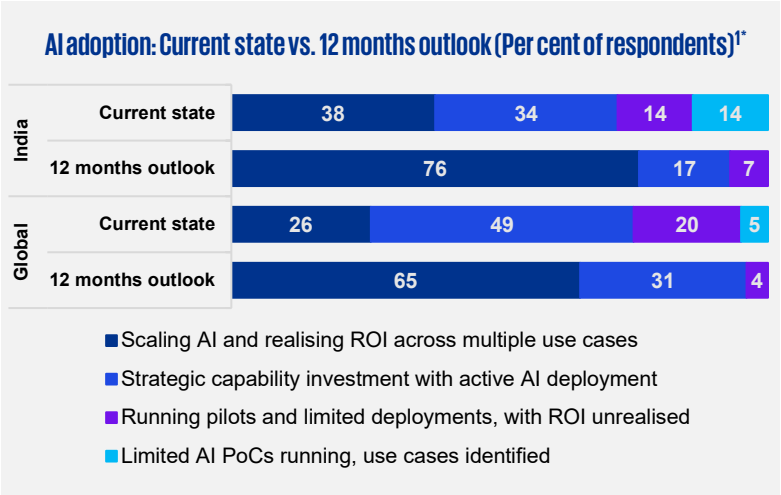
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2. Scaling AI from experimentation to business impact

AI integration is accelerating across financial services, moving from experimentation towards measurable value creation and enterprise-wide integration. The analysis compares Indian and global financial services organisations across AI maturity levels, investment priorities and trends, highlighting how these organisations are progressing from pilots to scalable, business-led AI transformation.

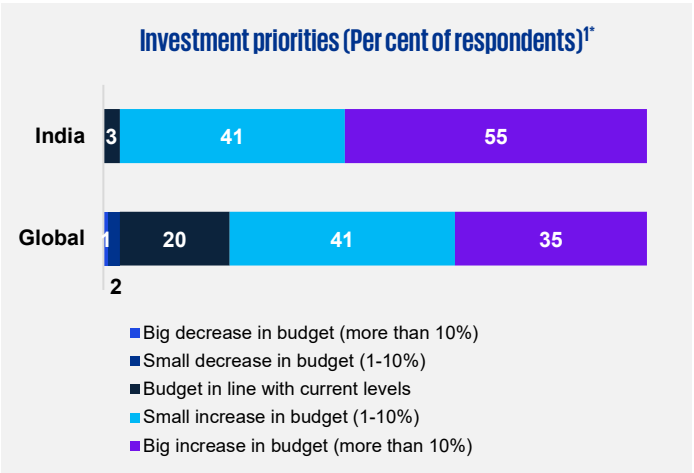
AI adoption maturity: From pilots to scaled deployment

- Indian financial organisations are showing visible momentum in deploying AI use cases into production at scale, delivering ROI across multiple use cases
- Key use cases include enhanced fraud detection and seamless digital payments, supporting greater customer trust, speed and transaction experience
- AI deployment at scale is expected to increase significantly over the next 12 months, reflecting growing confidence in AI's ability to generate measurable value across customer experience, operations and risk management.



Across both India and global fintechs, AI adoption is moving decisively from pilot initiatives towards scaled production, with firms increasingly focused on embedding the technology into core business functions and generating measurable business value, driving continued investment in AI scale-up initiatives.

AI investment outlook: Funding 12-month growth ambitions



- Indian organisations are increasingly inclined to scale AI initiatives beyond pilot programmes towards measurable business outcomes, as evident in their stronger appetite for AI budget increases
- Higher AI adoption, intensifying competition and the need to transform operational processes are driving organisations to move from pilots to value-driven AI deployment
- While global organisations continue to demonstrate sustained commitment to AI adoption, around one-fifth of them prefer to maintain their current investment levels, taking a measured approach to scaling AI.

The increase in AI budgets across Indian organisations highlights that AI remains a board-level priority. Beyond budget growth, organisations are shifting their focus from AI experimentation and isolated use cases to institutionalising AI, with greater emphasis on governance and value-realisation. Supported by strong technology talent and digital infrastructure, organisations are focused on translating AI investments into scalable capabilities, measurable business outcomes and enterprise-wide transformation.

ROI: Return on investment and PoC: Proof of concept

1. KPMG Global Tech Report 2026 Insights Hub, KPMG International, 20 January 2026

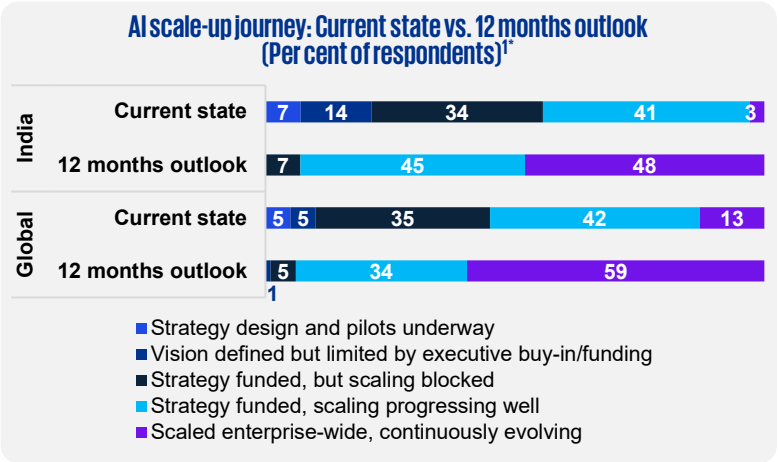
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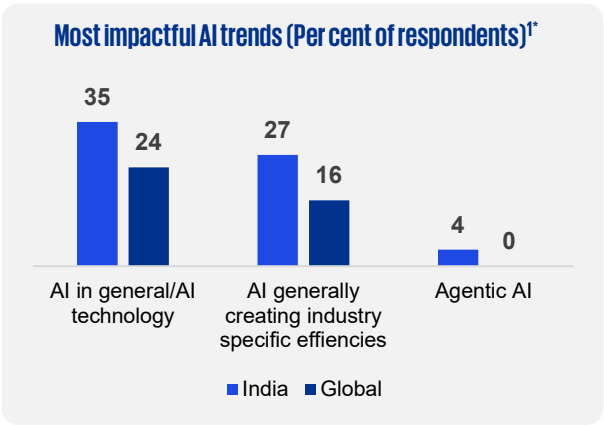
Enterprise AI maturity: Strategy, scale and evolution

- India and global organisations are moving from funded AI strategies to broader business-wide adoption, making AI a core capability rather than a pilot-led initiative
- The expected decline in organisations reporting funding and executive buy-in constraints over the near term indicates growing organisational commitment to AI adoption.

As AI strategies mature and budgets expand, fintech firms are expected to progress towards scaled AI and agentic AI deployment across core operations.



AI capabilities driving 2026 business impact



- Indian organisations report a greater emphasis on broad AI technology impact than global peers, reflecting the growing application of AI across business functions
- Organisations are increasingly embedding AI copilots across business functions to help employees navigate enterprise knowledge and automate repetitive activities, enhancing productivity and decision-making.
- With agentic AI still in its early stages, organisations expect near-term impact from mainstream AI copilots that may synthesise information, interpret policies and support day-to-day business decisions.

AI is increasingly viewed as both a transformational force and a practical business enabler. Nearly 93 per cent of Indian respondents believe that by the end of 2026, AI could evolve from an efficiency enabler to a revenue-driving innovation engine[1]. As AI becomes increasingly integrated across enterprise workflows, organisations are looking beyond productivity gains towards innovation and long-term competitive advantage.

Fintech transformation: AI-led scale and innovation

Overall, fintech adoption is moving towards a more integrated, real-time and intelligence-led model, with AI acting as the key accelerant across emerging trends. AI is enabling fintechs to build and launch products faster, serve previously unviable customer segments, reduce cost structures and strengthen decisioning across fraud, risk, compliance and customer engagement.

At the same time, embedded finance, open banking, instant payments, regtech, tokenised settlement and fintech-bank collaboration are converging to reshape how financial services are delivered and monetised. Supporting this evolution, innovation ecosystems and secure data access mechanisms are expected to remain important enablers of collaboration, experimentation and transformation across the fintech sector.

The next phase of fintech growth may depend on how effectively organisations scale these capabilities while maintaining trust, resilience, regulatory alignment and measurable business value.

1. KPMG Global Tech Report 2026 Insights Hub, KPMG International, 20 January 2026

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3. Real-world AI applications driving value across fintech

Fintech firms are increasingly embedding AI into core financial infrastructure rather than using it as a standalone digital layer. Key trends include real-time risk decisioning, agentic and conversational payments, AI-led customer servicing, predictive engagement and responsible AI governance.

These use cases show how AI is helping financial organisations improve transaction security, automate high-volume workflows and personalise customer journeys. They are also reducing servicing effort and unlocking new AI-native business models across payments, banking and digital commerce.

India: AI-native payment innovation

- A payments infrastructure provider launched an AI-enabled payment protocol that allows AI agents to execute pre-authorised transactions on behalf of users
- The solution enables secure, automated payments with built-in spending controls, compliance safeguards and user oversight.

- A digital payments provider adopted an AI-first model across merchant onboarding, payments, monitoring and customer journeys to deliver a smarter, seamless payment experience
- The initiative improved payment reliability, strengthened merchant operations and enabled more efficient payment acceptance while supporting profitable growth.

- A payments technology provider introduced AI-powered conversational payments, enabling customers to discover, decide and pay within chat or voice interactions
- The solution streamlined checkout, accelerated transactions and enabled secure AI-assisted payments while maintaining user trust, control and compliance.

Global: AI at scale in financial services

- A payments network used AI for real-time fraud detection and transaction risk assessment, enhancing payment security and customer experience
- The organisation established a robust AI governance framework to enable scalable, responsible AI adoption while maintaining compliance and operational reliability.

- A digital bank deployed a multi-agent AI system to conduct identity verification, analyse transactions and assess scam risk in parallel during fraud and dispute management processes
- The initiative compressed complex dispute workflows from weeks to days, with human reviewers engaged only for escalated, high-risk cases.

- An international bank deployed an AI-powered virtual assistant to deliver personalised financial guidance, recommendations and self-service support across banking and investment
- The initiative increased self-service adoption, reduced contact centre volumes and improved employee productivity by automating routine support requests.

These use cases highlight how AI is moving from experimentation to core business enablement across financial services. However, as adoption scales across payments, lending, customer service and operations, companies can ensure that AI systems remain transparent, fair, secure and accountable, making responsible AI guardrails critical for sustainable value creation.

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4. Responsible AI adoption: Key risks and guardrails

As GenAI and agentic AI become increasingly embedded across financial services, companies need to balance innovation with trust. Given AI's growing role in lending, fraud detection, investment decisions and customer engagement, Responsible AI is no longer just a compliance requirement, it is a business imperative. Strong guardrails around fairness, transparency, accountability and security are essential to ensure safe, ethical and scalable AI adoption in India's financial sector.

Model risk factors

- Biases, opaque decision-making and poor-quality data may result in inaccurate or unfair outcomes, particularly in lending and underwriting
- Strengthen data governance, model validation and explainability frameworks to ensure transparent, reliable and auditable AI-driven decisions.

Operational risk

- Model drift, system degradation and the amplification of errors across high-volume transactions could undermine decision quality and operational performance
- Implement continuous monitoring, retraining, stress testing and performance validation across the AI lifecycle.

Third-party risk

- Reliance on external vendors, cloud service providers and third-party or open-source software components may create hidden dependencies, service disruptions and software supply chain vulnerabilities, while limited visibility into vendor controls may hinder effective oversight
- Establish robust vendor governance, software bill of materials (SBOM) tracking, due diligence processes and ongoing third-party and supply chain risk assessments.

Liability and accountability challenges

- Non-deterministic AI outputs often make it difficult to allocate liability across stakeholders, exposing institutions to legal, regulatory and reputational risks
- Establish formal AI policies, board-level oversight, clear accountability structures, independent audits and incident management processes to govern AI-driven decisions and outcomes.

AI-driven collusion

- Autonomous AI systems may unintentionally coordinate pricing without adequate human oversight, raising concerns around fair competition and increasing the risk of market conduct violations
- Establish human oversight, governance controls and continuous monitoring to detect and mitigate unintended collusive behaviour.

Risks Suggested guardrails

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Financial stability risk

- AI-driven decision-making may contribute to procyclicality, model convergence risks and herding behaviour, potentially amplifying market volatility during disruptions
- Encourage rigorous stress testing, model diversity and continuous monitoring to strengthen resilience and mitigate systemic risks arising from AI-driven decision-making.

Cyber-security risk

- AI adoption may create new cybersecurity risks, including adversarial attacks, deepfakes, AI-enabled fraud and manipulating the training data set
- Strengthen AI security through continuous model testing, robust validation controls, threat monitoring and secure implementation practices to enhance resilience against evolving cyber risks.

Data privacy and security

- AI may increase exposure to data privacy arising from over collection of data, potential conflicts with data localisation requirements and extensive data aggregation
- Adopt privacy-by-design practices, data minimisation standards and advanced security controls to protect sensitive data and support adherence to evolving regulatory standards.

Consumer protection and ethics

- AI may introduce risks related to algorithmic bias, opaque decision-making and consumer manipulation, potentially widening financial exclusion and information asymmetries
- Implement enterprise-wide AI governance frameworks to promote transparent and ethical AI deployment in alignment with consumer protection and privacy requirements.

AI inertia

- Delayed AI adoption could weaken competitiveness, limit operational efficiency and result in missed opportunities in financial inclusion and innovation while keeping pace with AI-enabled threats
- Accelerate AI adoption through targeted use cases, scalable infrastructure and responsible AI frameworks to enhance resilience, inclusion and innovation across financial services.

Risks Suggested guardrails

Effectively managing these risks is critical to ensuring that AI-driven innovation remains trusted, resilient and sustainable. Beyond risk mitigation, realising AI's full potential may depend on building the foundations needed to support broader AI adoption and long-term value creation.

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5. Building the future of India's fintech ecosystem with AI

As AI reshapes the future of financial services globally, India's opportunity extends beyond adopting new technologies to building a distinctly Indian AI-native financial ecosystem. Achieving this vision may require a coordinated focus on governance, enterprise-scale adoption, emerging autonomous systems and sustained ecosystem development to ensure that innovation translates into long-term competitiveness and resilience.

Expand AI-ready infrastructure



While India's DPI provides a strong foundation for financial innovation, scaling AI requires greater access to compute resources, AI-ready datasets and interoperable data-sharing mechanisms to enable advanced applications across customer service, risk management and decision-making.

Strengthen responsible AI governance



As AI becomes embedded in critical financial decisions, strengthening governance frameworks across explainability, privacy, accountability, cybersecurity and model risk management may be essential to scaling AI responsibly while maintaining trust, compliance and resilience.

Scale AI across core financial functions



Realising broader AI impact may require enterprise-wide deployment across functions such as lending, underwriting, fraud detection, compliance, claims processing and customer engagement, helping enhance efficiency, improve decision-making and drive greater value creation.

Enable an agentic AI ecosystem



The next phase of AI adoption may involve autonomous agents capable of executing financial tasks and coordinating workflows with minimal human intervention, requiring trusted standards, interoperability frameworks, digital identity mechanisms and regulatory sandboxes for secure and accountable adoption.

Design for inclusive human computer interaction (HCI)



India's diverse language, literacy and digital-access landscape may require user-centric AI experiences, including voice-first, vernacular-language, low-bandwidth and accessibility-focused interfaces, to improve customer experience, inclusive user adoption and strengthen trust in AI-enabled financial services.

Leverage India's data strength



India's DPI ecosystem continues to create large-scale transaction, identity and behavioural datasets. Translating this data to develop indigenous AI models with credit, fraud and risk frameworks tailored to Indian consumer behaviour may enable fintechs to build more accurate, contextually relevant AI systems.

Taken together, these priorities represent a pathway for India to move from isolated AI deployments to a deeply integrated AI-native financial ecosystem. By balancing innovation with trust, fostering collaboration among stakeholders and investing in future-ready capabilities, India could establish itself at the forefront of responsible financial AI while delivering greater efficiency, inclusion and economic value at scale.

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